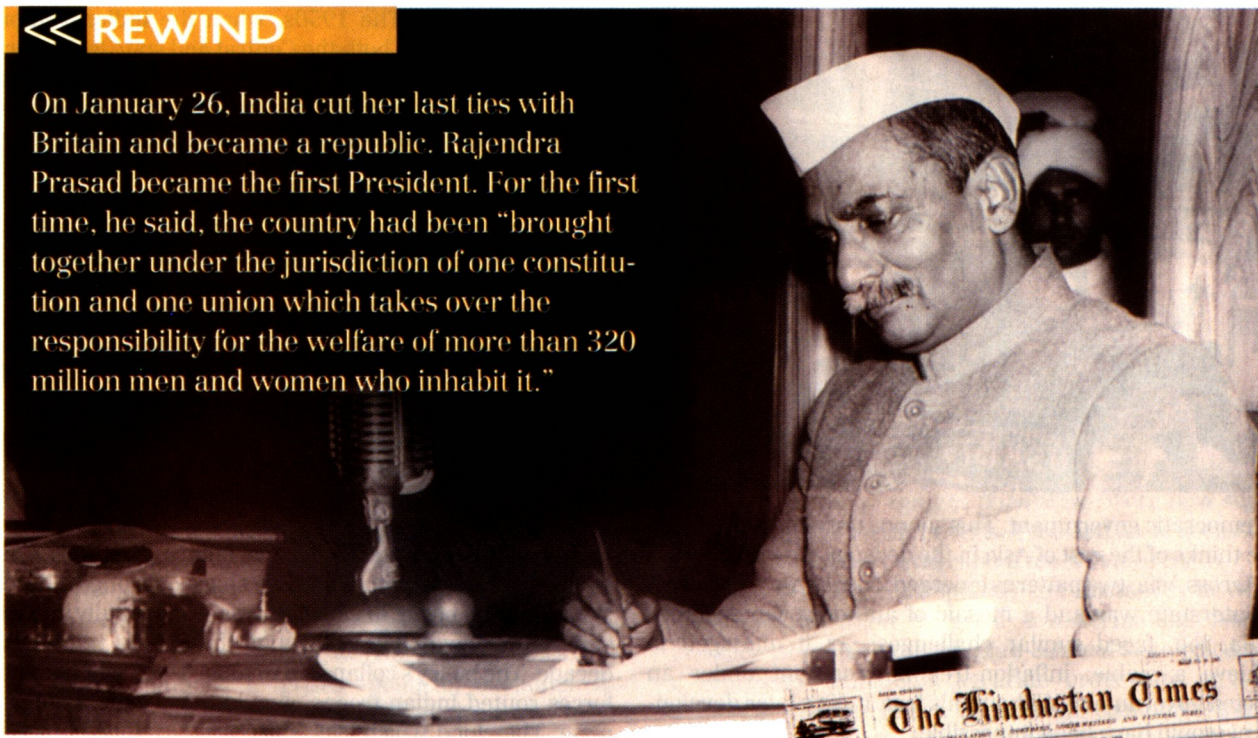


REPUBLIC OF HOPE

<< REWIND

On January 26, India cut her last ties with Britain and became a republic. Rajendra Prasad became the first President. For the first time, he said, the country had been "brought together under the jurisdiction of one constitution and one union which takes over the responsibility for the welfare of more than 320 million men and women who inhabit it."



Courtesy Nehru Memorial Museum and Library



ON SHAKY GROUND

On August 15, a massive earthquake shook Assam, its tremors felt even in Calcutta. Its magnitude was measured 8.6 on the Richter Scale with 1,526 deaths reported. Large landslides blocked the Subansiri River and when the natural dam broke eight days later, it created a wave 23 feet high submerging many villages and killing 536 people.



Courtesy Nehru Memorial Museum and Library

FIRST CUT

- Anna Rajan George of Tamil Nadu cadre became the first woman officer of the Indian Administrative Service.
- India's first destroyer squadron

- was formed after the country obtained three modern destroyers.
- Justice Hiralal J. Kania became the first Chief Justice of India.
- All 22 passengers killed in the first-ever air crash near Pathankot.

DIVINE LIGHT

Mother Teresa got permission from the Holy See to establish the order of the Missionaries of Charity. It began with only 12 nuns.